

1st Playtest (2/26)

Observations:

- Playtester 1:
 - The Playtester doesn't know they can roll by double-clicking.
 - They are trying to get off the cutting board.
 - The update menu appeared too frequently, preventing the playtester from focusing on the game.
 - They immediately noticed that he needed to dodge the spinning cleaver.
- Playtester 2:
 - They were confused about the map elements.
 - They didn't notice that the knife could damage them at first.
- Playtester 3:
 - After completing the game once, the amount of content you want to experience decreases drastically, and the enjoyment drops sharply.
- Playtester 4:
 - The use of "dash" in the game is not very significant. Some methods can be employed to enhance the effect of "dash". For example, adding some other functions to the dash.
 - There are many repetitive options during the upgrade process, and some options can be clearly seen as inferior to others. And there are very few options available. Currently, there are only three.
- Playtester 5:
 - The levels are too short.
 - The upgrade screen pops up too quickly.
 - The game got too easy when the player had too many upgrades.
- Playtester 6:
 - The speed parameter is set too high, allowing players to move quickly and disrupting the gameplay experience.
 - The enemy dies before it even gets close to the player.
- Playtester 7:
 - Character movement does not play a meaningful role in gameplay.

- As the game progresses, players rarely need to move to avoid enemy attacks. This removes tension and reduces engagement, since movement does not contribute to survival or tactical decision-making.
- Playtester 8:
 - Some enemies will appear off-screen, which may get stuck.
 - The player's level-up progress bar is very player-friendly.
- Playtester 9:
 - The automatic aiming system is very useful, even too good.
 - Enemy bullets are easy to dodge.
- Playtester 10:
 - The difficulty of the levels doesn't differ significantly, especially the second level, because by then the player's strength is clearly sufficient to "one-shot" enemies, but the number and strength of the enemies remain identical to the first level. The biggest highlight of the second level is the "Giant Cleaver."

Feedbacks:

- Playtester 1:
 - The difficulty of the enemies needs to be increased.
 - Add more UI elements, such as the cooldown time for the player's dash.
 - Add a counter of how many enemies are left in the current wave
- Playtester 2:
 - Try to remove placeholders and replace them with enemy sprites or map sprites. This will prevent players from getting confused.
- Playtester 3:
 - Low Replayability: new goals, unlocks, or challenges
 - Predictable Gameplay Loop: add Randomized Upgrade Pool and Hidden unlock skills
- Playtester 4:
 - We can add some features to dash, such as having an invincibility period after the dash, or being able to perform a special attack after the dash. We can also add some monsters and traps that must be avoided using dashes.

- Make the upgrade options into an upgrade tree. Players must start their selection at the first level of a particular branch, and they can only continue to choose the same branch for further upgrades after they have made this selection.
- Playtester 5:
 - Players level up very quickly, so perhaps the endless mode is more fun and has higher replayability.
 - Add an animation or effect to the upgrade page.
- Playtester 6:
 - The enemy's health is too low, and the player's firing range is too large, causing enemies to die before they even enter the player's line of sight. The player's firing range could be appropriately reduced.
 - The enemy shooter does not have an aiming animation, so they can be shot at suddenly.
 - The speed parameter is set too high, allowing players to move quickly and disrupting the gameplay experience.
 - The enemy dies before it even gets close to the player.
 - Ranged enemies do not aim, so they can be shot at suddenly.
- Playtester 7:
 - Character movement is completely useless; the only movement range is a small square in the middle, and later in the game, there's little need to "move to dodge."
 - Increase the enemy's ranged attack methods
- Playtester 8:
 - Change the enemy spawn logic to be near the player, and make them actively approach the player. Then ensure there are no off-screen obstacles preventing enemies from getting close. It would be best to add arrows pointing to any remaining enemies.
- Playtester 9:
 - Add an auto-attack switch
 - The enemy's bullets changed to more unpredictable trajectories.
- Playtester10:
 - Increase enemy damage and health, and add more terrain traps. Increase the damage of terrain traps.

- Decrease the frequency of XP and upgrades so the player doesn't get too strong too fast.